

participate in, financial behaviour that sabotages our goals. This isn't a judgement, or even tough love, but simply an observation that I've made time and time again in my own relationship with money and that of others. It's indicative of a need to connect what we repeatedly do with our progress towards our goals, and also how we feel, which leads us neatly on to Step Three, which is all about creating rituals and habits around money.

Concluding thoughts for Step Two

I really hope that this second step has helped you to think differently about how your finances relate to your self-worth, and what areas you need to work on to try to draw a line between the two. It's so easy to over-simplify this relationship, but in expanding our viewpoint to cover other areas, such as work and relationships, and how these feed into the relationship between our money and our self-worth, we start to feel more able to understand and then resolve them. There's a reason why I say that changing your relationship with money can change your whole life, and this step – learning and accepting that your worth stands independently of your financial status, setting boundaries and stepping off that hedonic treadmill are things that will trickle (or maybe even flow freely) into other areas of your life – is so key in that it's inevitable.

To complete this step, I'd like you to think about why money is important to you – why you want more of it, and why you want to find a sense of peace in your relationship with it.